

BASIC SIGHT-SINGING AND EAR TRAINING FOR CHURCH SINGERS

PITCH EXERCISES 7.2 – STICHERA TONES SUNG WITH DRONE (ISON)



INSTRUCTIONS FOR PITCH EXERCISES 7.2

Using the Virtual Piano Keyboard here: <https://virtualpiano.net/?instr=organ> (set to “Organ”), find the specified note for each exercise. (Click Key Assist twice if you need help finding the note). As you sustain the drone pitch on the keyboard, sing each sticheron melody, using text or SOL-FA syllables. Listen to the **vertical intervals** that occur as your voice moves up and down against the sustained drone in the background.

IMPORTANT: In certain phrases or on the Final Note, you may be asked to **change the sustained pitch. Follow the notes on the slides.**

Record your singing.

For “extra credit” write down the names of the intervals (e.g. “major third,” “perfect fourth,” etc.)

STICHERON TONE 1 - SUSTAINED PITCH: C

Theotokion Dogmatikon - Tone 1



Let us praise the Vir-gin **Ma** - ry, the gate of heaven, the



glo - ry of the world, the song of the angels, the beauty of the



faith - ful! She was born of **man**, yet gave **birth** to God.

STICHERON TONE 1 - 2



She was re-vealed as *the* heav-en, as the temple of the God - head.

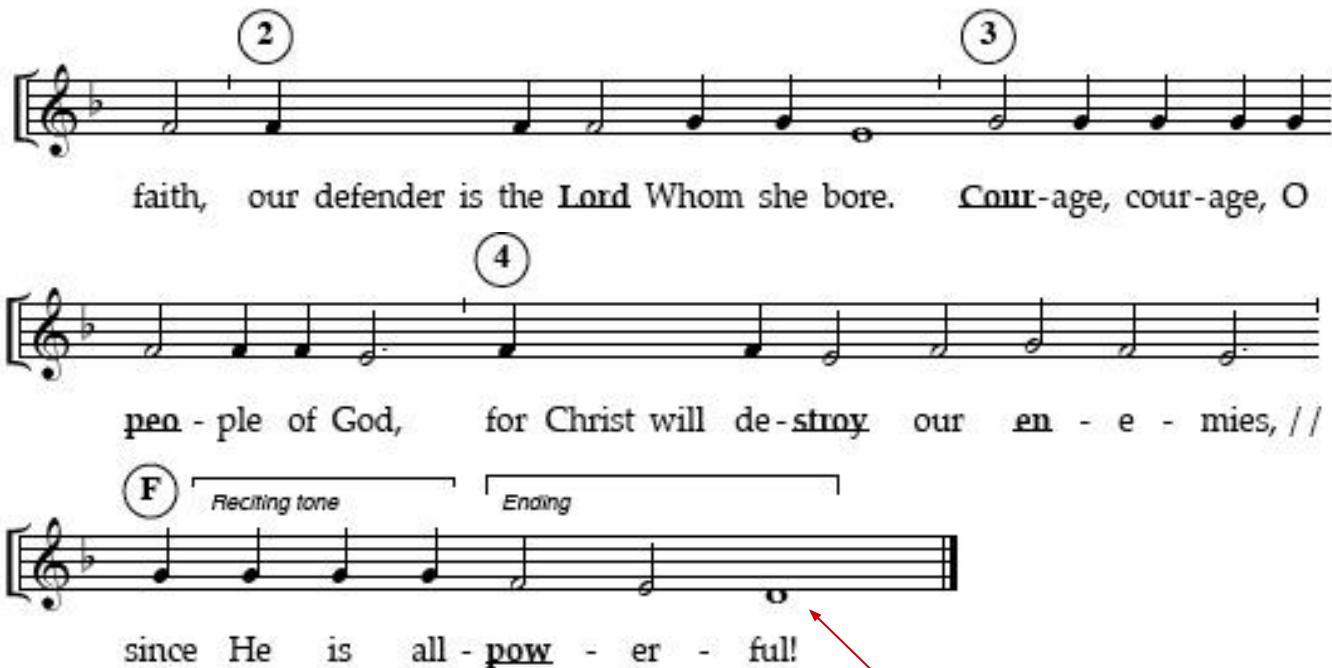


She de-stroyed the wall of en-mi - ty. She commenced the peace; she



o - pened the King - dom. Since she is our *foun*-da - tion of

STICHERON TONE 1 - 3



The image displays three staves of musical notation for Sticheron Tone 1-3. The first staff is marked with a circled '2' and contains the lyrics 'faith, our defender is the Lord Whom she bore. Cour-age, cour-age, O'. The second staff is marked with a circled '4' and contains the lyrics 'pen - ple of God, for Christ will de-~~stroy~~ our en - e - mies, //'. The third staff is marked with a circled 'F' and contains the lyrics 'since He is all - pow - er - full!'. Above the third staff, a bracket labeled 'Reciting tone' spans the first four notes, and another bracket labeled 'Ending' spans the last four notes. A red arrow points to the final note of the third staff, which is a D note.

2

3

4

F

Reciting tone

Ending

faith, our defender is the Lord Whom she bore. Cour-age, cour-age, O

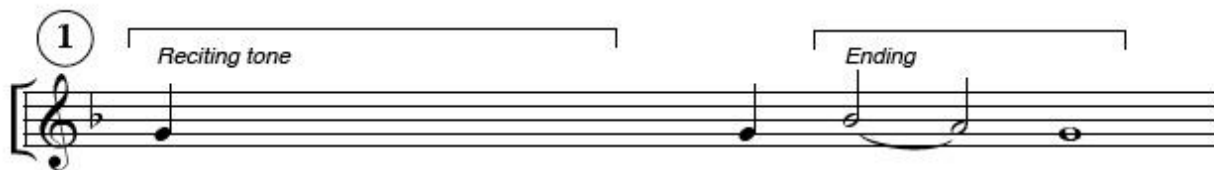
pen - ple of God, for Christ will de-~~stroy~~ our en - e - mies, //

since He is all - pow - er - full!

Final note changes to D

STICHERON TONE 2 - SUSTAINED PITCH: D

Theotokion Dogmatikon - Tone 2



The shadow of the Law passed when **grace** came!



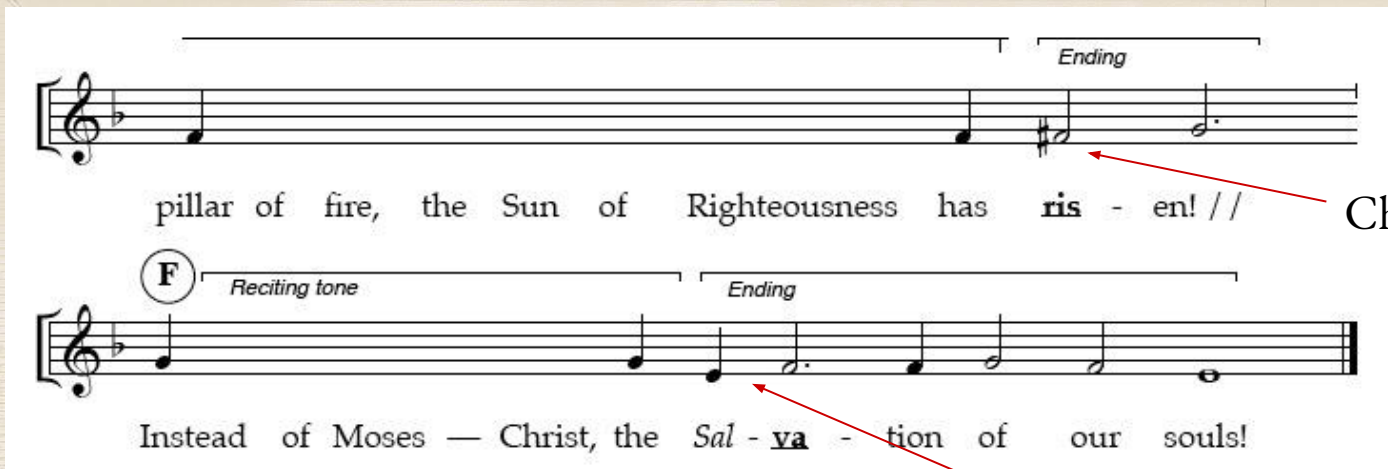
As the bush burned, yet was **not** con - sumed, so the

Change to C



Vir - gin gave birth, yet remained a **vir** - gin! Instead of the

STICHERON TONE 2 - 2



The image displays two staves of musical notation for the Sticheron Tone 2 - 2. The first staff is in G-clef and F major, with a key signature of one flat. It features a reciting tone (F) and an ending. The lyrics are: "pillar of fire, the Sun of Righteousness has **ris** - en! //". A red arrow points from the word "ris" to the text "Change to D". The second staff is in G-clef and F major, with a key signature of one flat. It features a reciting tone (F) and an ending. The lyrics are: "Instead of Moses — Christ, the **Sal - va** - tion of our souls!". A red arrow points from the word "va" to the text "Change to C".

pillar of fire, the Sun of Righteousness has **ris** - en! //

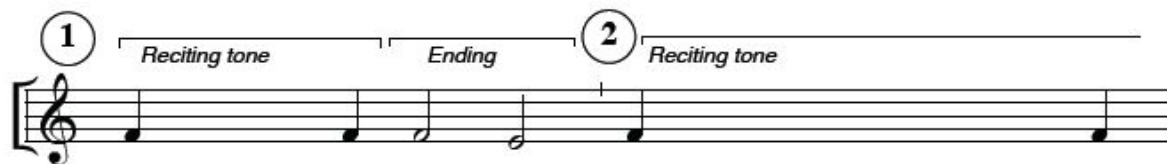
Instead of Moses — Christ, the **Sal - va** - tion of our souls!

Change to D

Change to C

STICHERON TONE 3 - SUSTAINED PITCH: C

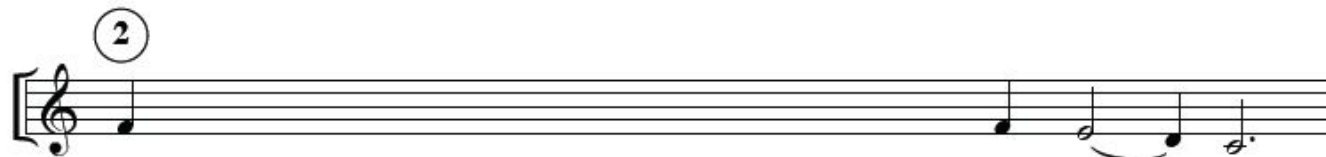
Theotokion Dogmatikon - Tone 3



How can we not **won** - der at Your mystical childbearing,

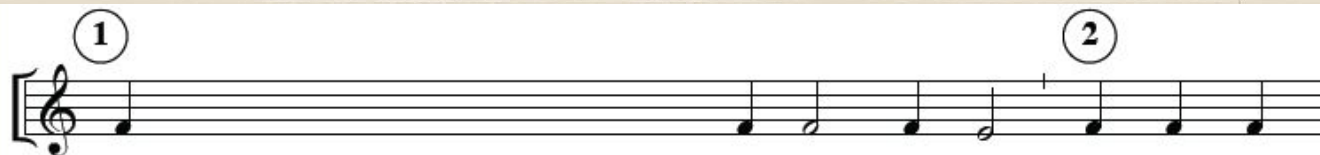


O Exalted **Moth** - er? For, without receiving the **touch** of man,



you gave birth to a Son in the flesh, O Immaculate **Vir** - gin.

STICHERON TONE 3 - 2



The Son born of the Father before e - ~~ter~~ - ni - ty was born of



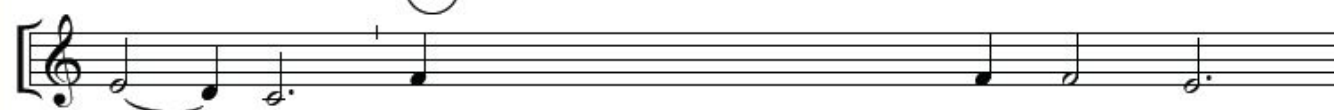
you at the fulness of time, O Honored **La** - dy. He underwent no



mingling, no change, no di - **vis** - ion; but preserved the fulness of each

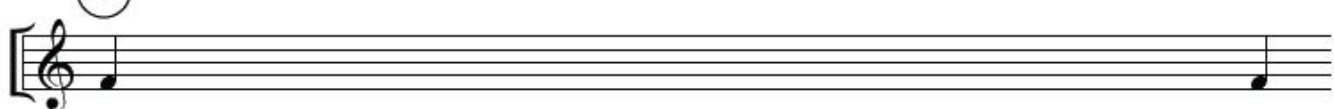
STICHERON TONE 3 - 3

①



na - ture. Entreat Him, O Lady and Virgin **Moth** - er,

②



to save the souls of those who confess you in the Orthodox

③

Reciting tone *Ending*



man - ner // to **be** the The - o - **to** - kos!

STICHERON TONE 4 - SUSTAINED PITCH: C

Theotokion Dogmatikon - Tone 4

1 Reciting tone Ending 2 Reciting tone

The prophet David was a fa - ther of the Lord through you, O

Ending 3 Beginning Reciting tone Ending

Vir - gin. He fore - told in songs the One who worked won - ders in

4 Reciting tone Ending

you: "At Your right hand stood the Queen, Your Moth - er,"

STICHERON TONE 4 - 2

5 Reciting tone Ending

the mediatrix of life, since God was freely born of her with - out a

3a Reciting tone Ending

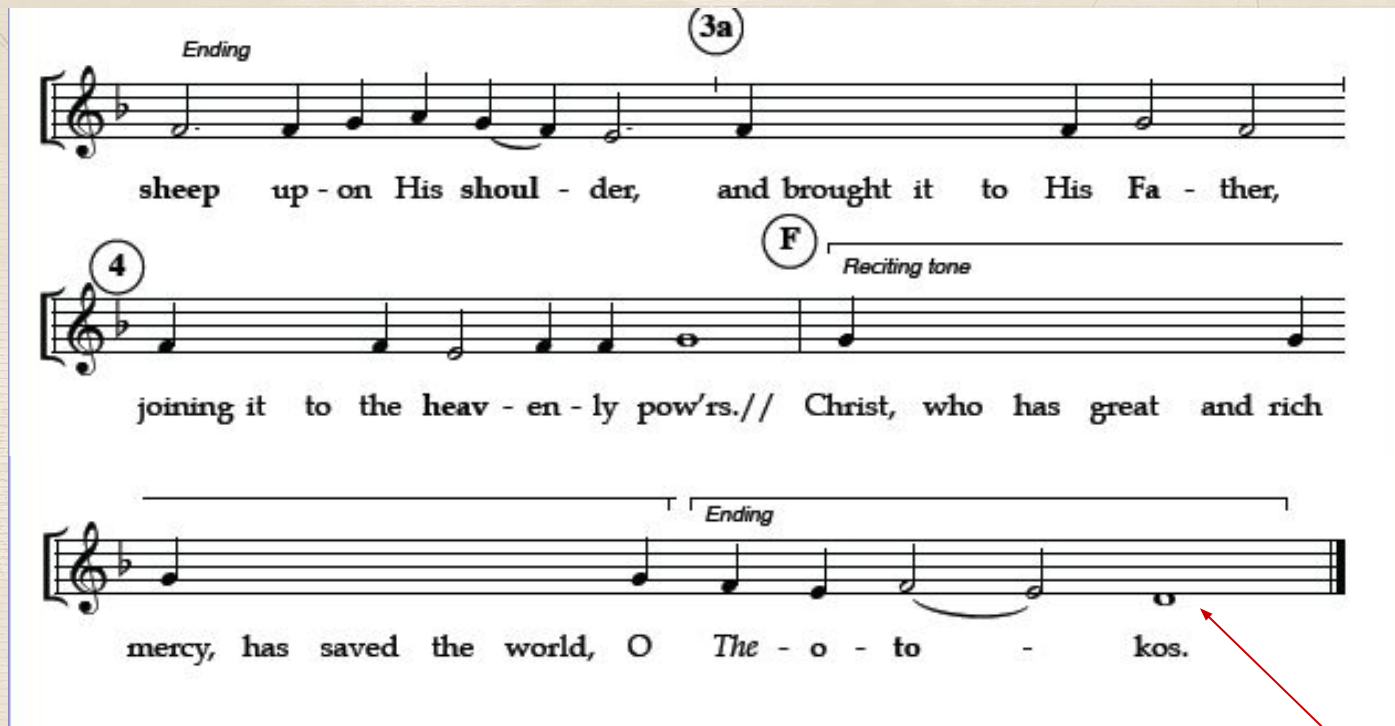
fa - ther. He wanted to renew His fall - en im - age,

4 5

made cor - rupt in pas - sion; so He took the lost

The musical score is written on three staves. The first staff begins with a circled '5' and the label 'Reciting tone', followed by a bracketed 'Ending' section. The second staff begins with a circled '3a' and the label 'Reciting tone', followed by a bracketed 'Ending' section. The third staff begins with a circled '4' and ends with a circled '5'. The lyrics are written below the staves, with hyphens indicating syllables that span across notes.

STICHERON TONE 4 - 3



The musical score is written on three staves in G-clef and F-sharp key signature. The first staff begins with a treble clef and a key signature of one sharp (F#). It contains a melodic line with a fermata over the eighth measure. Above the staff, the word "Ending" is written above the first measure, and a circled "3a" is above the eighth measure. The lyrics "sheep up - on His shoul - der, and brought it to His Fa - ther," are written below the staff. The second staff begins with a circled "4" above the first measure. Above the staff, a circled "F" is above the fifth measure, and the words "Reciting tone" are written below the staff. The lyrics "joining it to the heav - en - ly pow'rs.// Christ, who has great and rich" are written below the staff. The third staff begins with a treble clef and a key signature of one sharp (F#). Above the staff, the word "Ending" is written above the eighth measure. The lyrics "mercy, has saved the world, O The - o - to - kos." are written below the staff. A red arrow points to the final note (D) of the third staff.

Ending

(3a)

sheep up - on His shoul - der, and brought it to His Fa - ther,

(4)

(F) Reciting tone

joining it to the heav - en - ly pow'rs.// Christ, who has great and rich

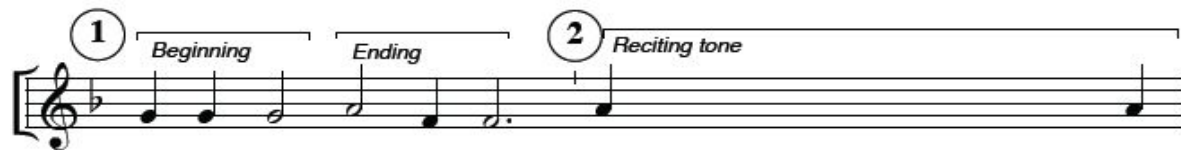
Ending

mercy, has saved the world, O The - o - to - kos.

Final note changes to D

STICHERON TONE 5 - SUSTAINED PITCH: C

Theotokion Dogmatikon - Tone 5



In the **Red Sea** of old, a type of the Virgin Bride was pre-

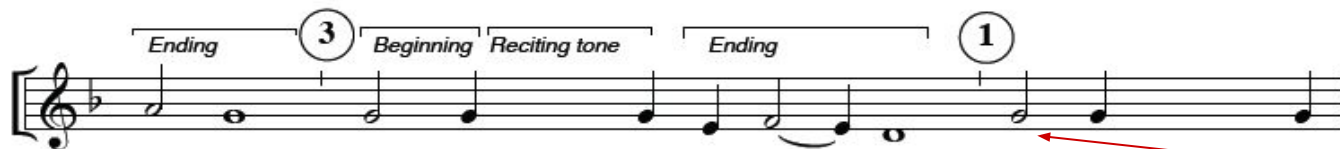


fig-ured. **There** Moses divided the **wa** - ters; **here** Gabriel assisted

Back to C



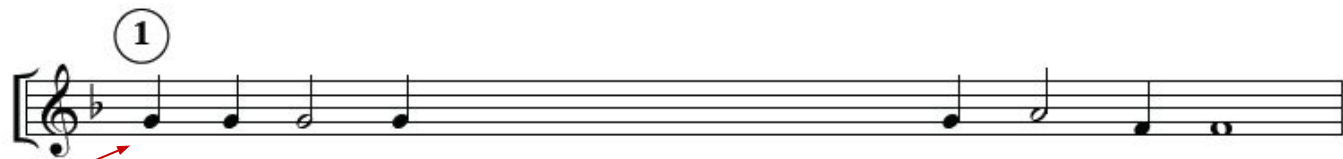
in the **mir** - a - cle. There Israel crossed the sea without **get** - ting

STICHERON TONE 5 - 2



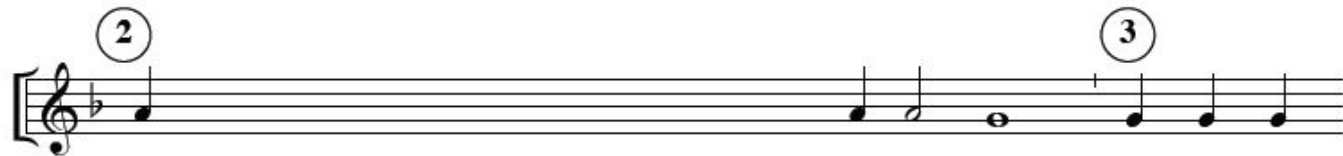
wet. **here** the Virgin gave birth to **Christ** with - out seed.

Change to D



Back to C

Af - ter **Is** - rael's passage, the sea remained im - **pass** - a - ble;



after Emmanuel's birth, the Virgin remained a **Vir** - gin. Ev - er - ex -

STICHERON TONE 5 - 3

The image shows a musical staff in G-clef with a key signature of one flat (B-flat). The melody consists of quarter notes and half notes. Above the staff, a circled 'F' is positioned over a half note. Below the staff, the lyrics are: 'ist - ing God, who ap-peared as man, // O Lord, have mer-cy on us!'. Red arrows point from the text 'Change to D' to the word 'peared', from 'Change to C' to the word 'mer', and from 'Back to D' to the word 'us!'. Above the staff, the words 'Reciting tone' and 'Ending' are written with a bracket spanning from the 'Reciting tone' section to the end of the staff.

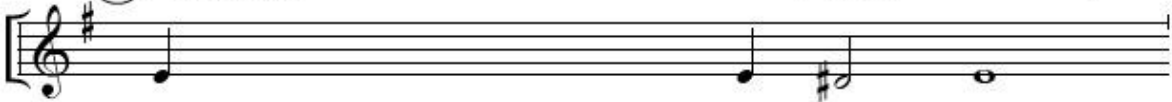
ist - ing God, who ap-peared as man, // O Lord, have mer-cy on us!

Change to D Change to C Back to D

STICHERON TONE 6 - SUSTAINED PITCH: B

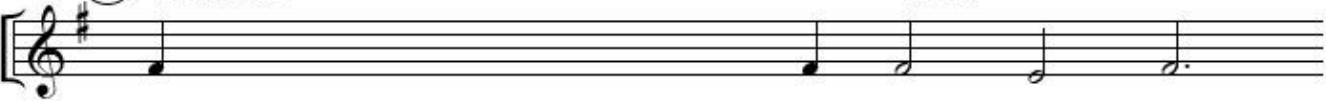
Theotokion Dogmatikon - Tone 6

1 *Reciting tone* *Ending*



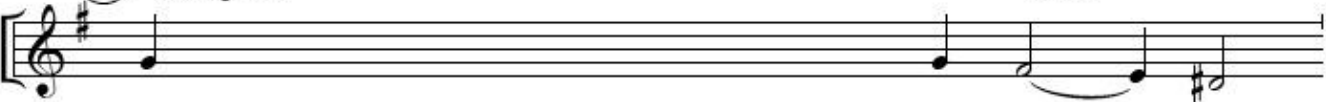
Who will not bless you, most holy **Vir** - gin?

2 *Reciting tone* *Ending*



Who will not sing of your most pure **child** - bear - ing?

3 *Reciting tone* *Ending*



The only-begotten Son shone timelessly from the **Fa** - ther,

TONE 6 - STICHERON (COMMON CHANT) - 2

1 2

but from you He was ineffably in - **car** - nate! God by nature, yet

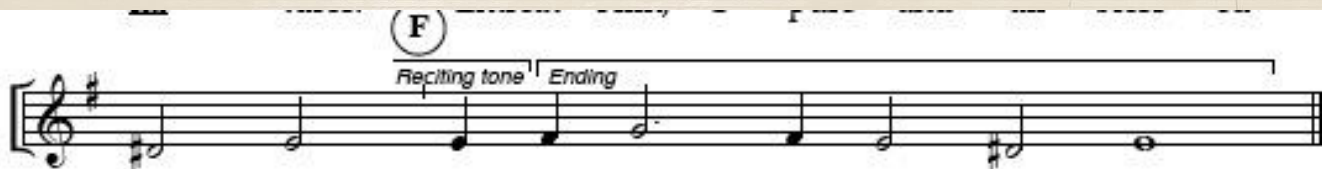
3

man for our sake! Not two persons, but one — known in two

1

na - tures! Entreat Him, O pure and all - bless - ed

TONE 6 - STICHERON (COMMON CHANT) - 3



La - dy, // to have mer - cy on our souls!

Alternative final phrase:



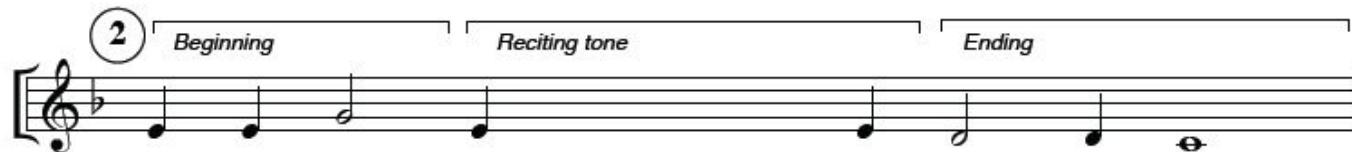
to have mer - cy on our souls!

STICHERON TONE 7 - SUSTAINED PITCH: C

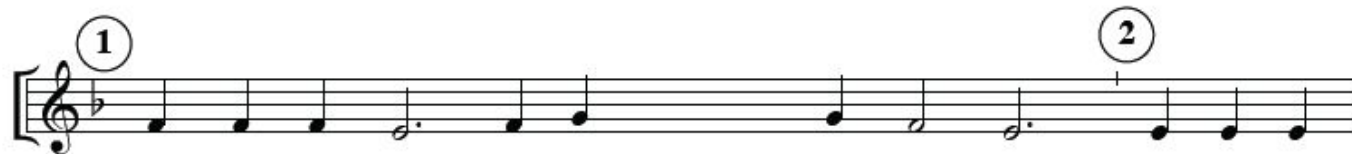
Theotokion Dogmatikon - Tone 7



No tongue can speak of your won - der - ful child - bear - ing



for the or - der of nature was over - ruled by God.



You were re - vealed to be a mother above na - ture, for you re -

TONE 7 - STICHERON (COMMON CHANT) - 2

mained a virgin beyond reason and under - stand - ing. Your con -

cep - tion was most glorious, O Theo - to - kos. The man - ner of your

giving birth was ineffable, O Vir - gin. Know - ing you to be the

TONE 7 - STICHERON (COMMON CHANT) - 3

Moth - er of God, de - vout - ly we pray to you:

Reciting tone Ending

"Be - seech Him to save our souls."

Final note changes to D

STICHERON TONE 8 - SUSTAINED PITCH - A

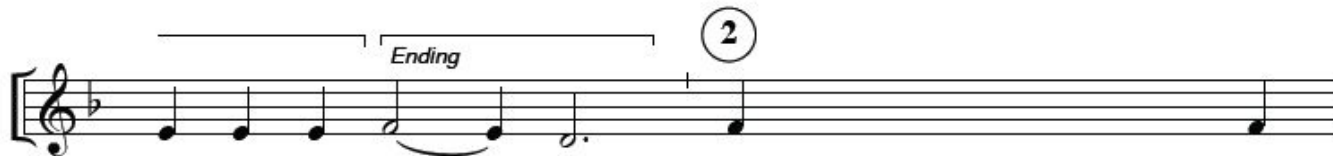
Theotokion Dogmatikon - Tone 8



The **King** of **Heav** - en, because of His **love** — for man,

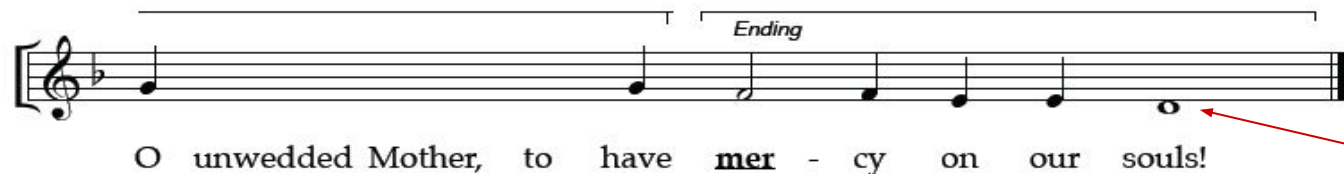
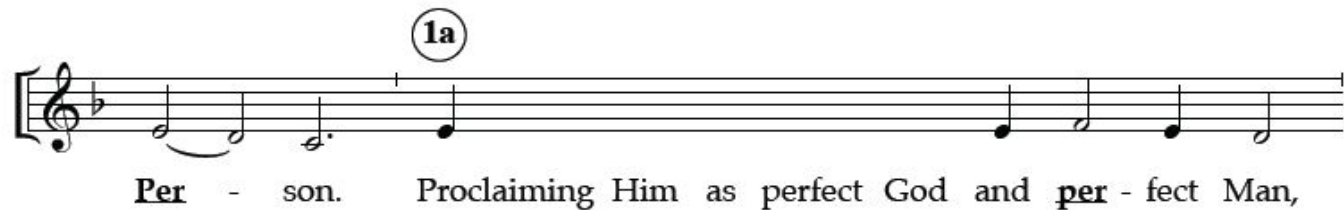
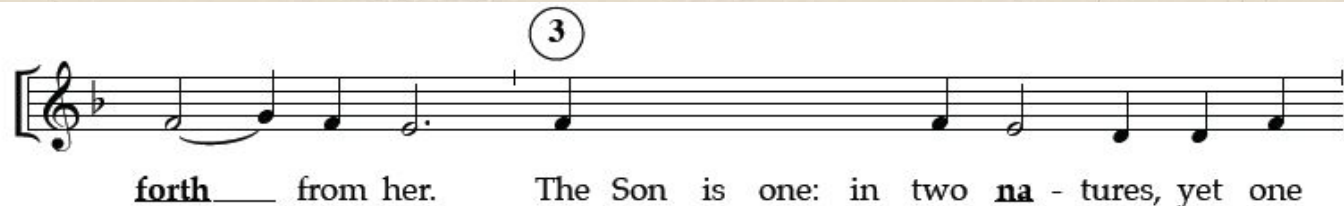


ap-peared on **earth** — and **dwelt** with men. He took flesh



from the pure **Vir** - gin, and after assuming it, He came

STICHERON TONE 8 - 2



Congratulations!

You should now have the medieval sound of a melody over a sustained drone and the resulting vertical intervals well in your ear!

